

SOCIAL

Canadian Communities Study Guide

An overview of urban, rural, and remote communities in Canada — useful for review and conversation at home.

Canada's communities are often grouped into three types, based on population size and distance from services. Use this guide to review the differences and talk about which type of community your family lives in — and why.

Type	What it looks like	Example
Urban	Densely packed, many people, tall buildings, lots of services	Toronto, Vancouver, Montreal (Transit, hospitals, schools nearby)
Rural	Spread out, fewer people, farmland or small towns, longer distances between services	Small towns in southern Ontario
Remote	Very few people, far from big cities, limited road access, services (like doctors) may be quite a ways away	Coastal communities in Nunavut

Think & Talk About It

- Which type of community do we live in? What clues tell us that?
- What services are close to us? What services are far away?
- Why might someone choose to live in a rural or remote community instead of a city?
- How might daily life be different for a child growing up in a remote community?